

Chris Melançon – Land Steward

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Regenerative land steward, licensed master falconer, and operating executive with three decades of experience, leading technology organizations, managing working lands, and operating in regulated, resource-constrained environments. Built a diversified regenerative farm from dormant pasture, led the turnaround of a 12-acre certified-organic educational farm, and co-founded two startups focused on ecological monitoring and analytics. Brings P&L leadership, government affairs experience, and founder-level ownership to every engagement.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Land Stewardship Plan Development • Permaculture & Ecological Planting Design • Regenerative Agriculture & Holistic Land Management • Environmental Sensors & Analytics • Agricultural Zoning, Permitting & County Relations • Grant Writing & Government Affairs (USDA and other state/federal programs) • Licensed Master Falconer & Raptor Rehabilitator • On-Site Land Management & Self-Sufficient Living • Farm-to-Table, CSA & Educational Programming • P&L Leadership & General Management • Community & Volunteer Coordination

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal

June 2022 - Present

What Feeds You, LLC (Advisory practice powered by an AI Agent Team)

- Advise land stewards, homesteaders, and small-scale producers on regenerative agriculture, holistic management, and permaculture design, translating ecological principles into practical, resilient operating models for soil health, nutritious food, and living ecosystems. Developed an AI-native application as the technology backbone of the advisory practice.
- Create land stewardship plans for farming and ranching operations to enhance biodiversity and climate resilience.

Chief Executive Officer

2024 - 2025

Stratifyx, Inc., Boulder, CO

- Led an early-stage company building data-driven decision tools for land and environmental management.
- Positioned the company for a successful strategic acquisition by Pantheon Regeneration.

Executive Director & Farm Manager

2021 - 2022

Fairview Gardens Farm, Santa Barbara, CA

- Led the turnaround of a 12-acre certified-organic educational community farm delivering 30,000+ lbs of produce annually, catalyzed the redesign of the operating model for long-term financial and ecological sustainability.
- Partnered with the board of trustees and the organization's founder to initiate the reset of strategic direction and rebuilding of community and educational programming.

Co-Founder & Agrarian

2013 - 2021

LOLA Sonoma Farms, Sonoma, CA

- Built and operated a diversified regenerative farm business from 12 acres of dormant pasture, owning financials, production, processing, marketing, and distribution across produce, dairy, eggs, honey, pork, and lamb.
- Secured USDA grants for soil health and ecosystem resilience; established go-to-market partnerships with farmers' markets and a county ecology center to feed and educate the community.
- Hosted more than 100 aspiring farmers and environmentally conscious volunteers through the Worldwide Opportunities on Organic Farms (WWOOF-USA) program.

Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer

2008 - 2018

Spyglass Technologies, Inc., San Francisco, CA

- Founded and led an environmental diagnostics company commercializing portable laboratory systems for water and ecosystem monitoring, leveraging genomics and mass spectrometry, owning the innovation pipeline from concept through commercial launch.

- Secured seed financing and completed in-licensing and manufacturing agreements to win contracts with the U.S. EPA, NSF, Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution, and Monterey Bay Aquarium Research Institute.
- Established an in-house assay validation lab to expand the test menu; grew revenue to approximately \$1M annually with limited external capital.

Vice President, Business Development

2008 - 2009

Enigma Diagnostics, Salisbury, UK

- Led U.S. market entry for a UK-based molecular diagnostics company, evaluating and executing strategic partnerships and out-licensing agreements.
- Opened the U.S. office and launched an influenza testing portfolio across U.S. and East Asian markets, including participation in U.S. military field trials.

General Manager

2004 - 2008

Applied Biosystems (Life Technologies / Thermo Fisher Scientific), Foster City, CA

- Held full P&L responsibility for a \$50M business unit delivering early-warning molecular diagnostics for infectious disease surveillance and biosecurity threats.
- Commercialized a new testing portfolio in 60+ countries within 15 months and led a high-growth pathogen-testing program for the U.S. Postal Service.
- Built and executed a government affairs strategy that advanced biodefense and infectious disease legislation, coordinating directly with regulators and legislators.

EARLY CAREER

- Director, Product Marketing, Oracle, Inc. (via Siebel Systems): led marketing of vertical applications within a \$150M enterprise software product line.
- Director, Product Marketing, OnLink Technologies, Inc.: managed the product portfolio for a B2B software company acquired by Siebel Systems.
- Chief of Staff / Product Manager, Citigroup/Citibank: managed operations and strategic planning for a technology division.
- Infantry Officer – Airborne/Ranger, U.S. Army: led operations and personnel in high-accountability environments.

EDUCATION

Masters of the Environment - University of Colorado, Boulder

B.S., Applied Physics - Colorado State University

MBA - Tulane University

B.S., Mechanical Engineering - United States Military Academy, West Point

LAND STEWARDSHIP, FALCONRY & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- California-licensed Master Falconer and Raptor Rehabilitator, 2016 - Present
- Board Treasurer, Wonderhaven dba "Dharma's Garden," Boulder, CO, 2024 - Present
- Board Member, The McNab Stockdog Foundation, 2023 - Present
- Board Member, Applied Ecological Institute, 2024 - 2025
- Board Member, Think Blue Data, Ltd, Bangkok, Thailand, 2013 - 2024
- Member, Farmer Veteran Coalition, 2023 - Present
- Member, North American Falconers Association, 2016 - Present